

USING THE SKY GUIDES

- 62–63 The celestial sphere
- 64–67 Celestial cycles
- 68–69 Planetary motion
- 70–73 Star motions and patterns

SPECIAL EVENTS

PHASES OF THE MOON

	FULL MOON	NEW MOON
2020	January 10	January 24
2021	January 28	January 13
2022	January 17	January 2
2023	January 6	January 21
2024	January 25	January 11
2025	January 13	January 29
2026	January 3	January 18

SPECIAL EVENTS CALENDAR

The introduction to each month contains a Special Events table, which lists the dates of full and new moons and events such as lunar and solar eclipses and planetary conjunctions and transits (see p.69). This table also lists the dates when Mercury is at greatest elongation.

THIS MONTH-BY-MONTH GUIDE to the night sky features charts that show the whole sky as it appears from most places on Earth's surface. It complements the CONSTELLATIONS section, in which detailed maps show smaller areas of sky. For each month, text, tables, and supporting charts identify good objects for observation and show the positions of the planets.

MONTHLY HIGHLIGHTS AND PLANET LOCATORS

For each month of the year, a double-page introductory highlights different phenomena in the sky. Dates of special events, such as phases of the Moon and eclipses, are listed year-by-year in a table. The main text describes those stars, deep-sky objects, and meteor showers that feature prominently in that particular month—this text complements the whole-sky charts that follow. The

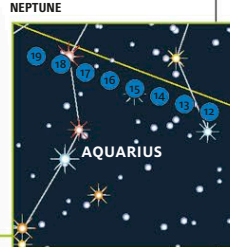
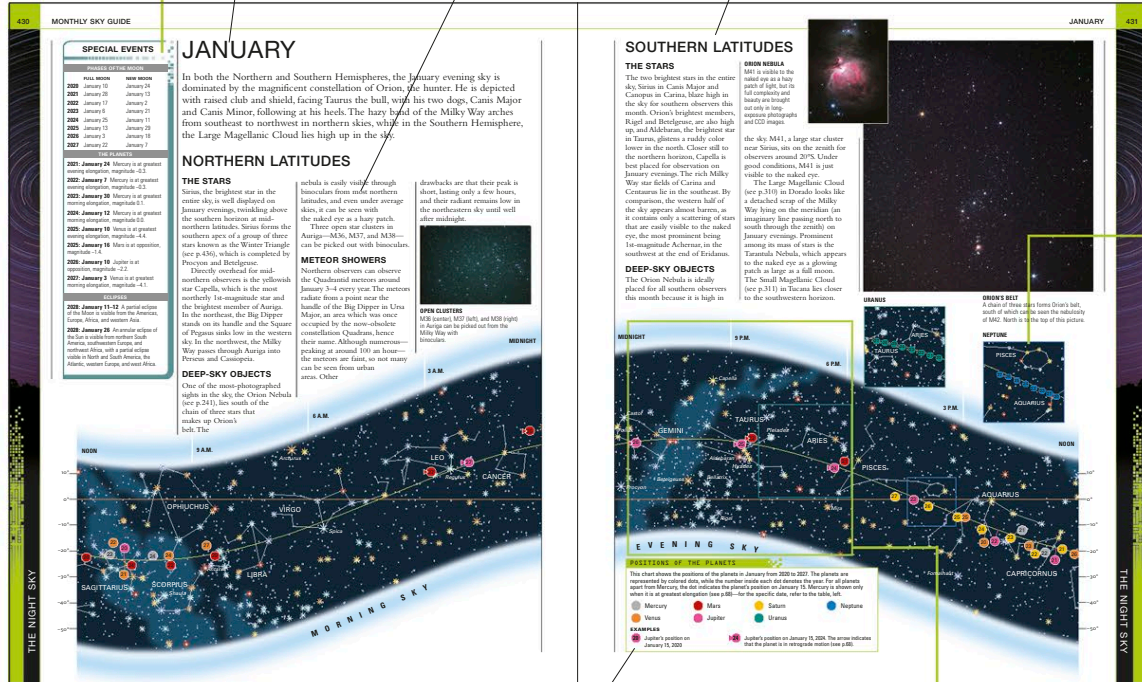
introductory pages also feature a planet locator chart. This map shows the band of sky that lies on either side of the ecliptic, the plane close to which the planets always appear. These charts should be used in conjunction with the extra information supplied in the Special Events table, as well as the whole-sky charts and the individual constellation entries (see pp.354–425).

each month of the year has its own introductory pages

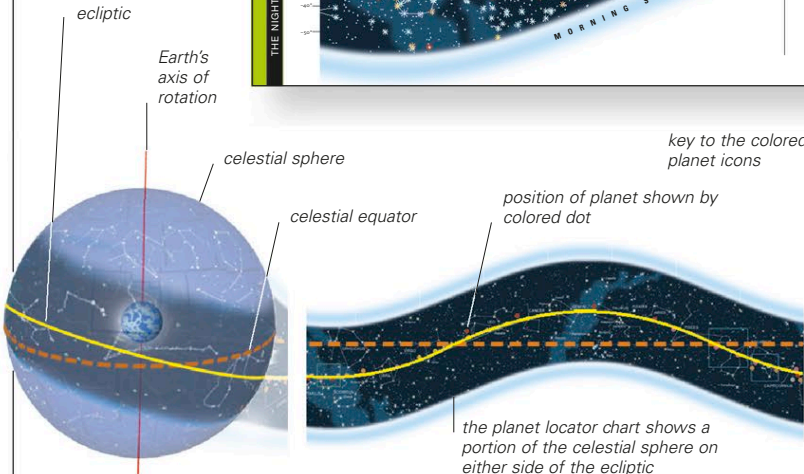
the text highlights the most prominent stars, deep-sky objects, and meteor showers

observation from northern and southern latitudes is covered separately in the text

photographs illustrate some of the most interesting features to be observed



THE OUTER PLANETS
The two outermost planets, Uranus and Neptune, are shown on magnified insets of the main chart because they move relatively slowly through our sky.



PLANET LOCATOR CHARTS △
These charts show the positions of the planets at 10:00 p.m. local standard time on the 15th day of the month. Each planet is represented by a different-colored dot, and the number inside the dot refers to a particular year. Each chart shows the planets' positions in relation to the 13 constellations along the ecliptic (see p.65), the area in which the planets are always found.

THE INNER PLANETS ▽
The six planets closest to the Sun are represented on the main body of the chart. Bands along the top and bottom indicate in local time when that area of sky is highest in the sky. However, local sunset and sunrise times will affect the darkness of the sky and thus the visibility of the planets.

